

Informix Software Overview

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Agenda

- The company
- Database products & technology
- Client-server application development tools
- Services
- Aberdeen Group Findings

Company Overview

- A Top-10 Independent Software Vendor
- Fastest growing independent RDBMS company
- A respected rival of Oracle and Sybase

Company Characteristics

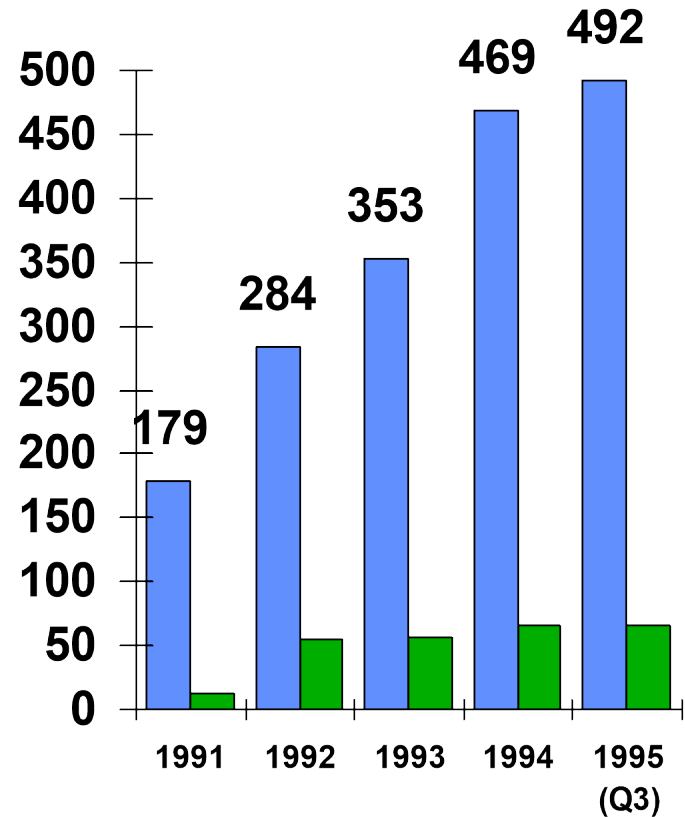
- Technology concentration on superior RDBMS and tools
- Small service and consulting business
- Key markets are Telecommunications, Retail, Financial Services, Manufacturing, and State/Local Government

Changing Strategy

- Historical indirect-channel focus
 - Many have Informix-based apps and don't know it
 - 1,000s of VAR & ISV partners and applications
- Recent thrust into Fortune 1000 with direct sales

Financial Overview

- Five year growth rates
- Profitability



Databases

- Standard Engine
- OnLine
 - Informix-OnLine
 - Dynamic Server
 - Extended Parallel Server
 - Specialized versions
 - OnLine/Secure
 - OnLine/Optical

Informix SE

- Designed for distributed, replicated systems
 - Example: retail stores and bank branches
- Was used as small Unix server
- Now positioned as personal/workgroup RDBMS

Informix SE Characteristics

- High performance
- Small memory and disk footprint
- Very easy to install & maintain
- Rock-solid operations
- Low cost
- Competes with Gupta, Progress, Sybase/Watcom SQL Anywhere

Informix-OnLine

- Entry-level product for scalable applications
 - OnLine -> OnLine Dynamic Server -> Extended Parallel Server
- Powerful RDBMS for OLTP
- Includes
 - stored procedures
 - triggers
 - referential integrity
 - document-imaging support (BLOBS)
- Frequently used for hardware vendor Transaction Processing Council TPC-C OLTP benchmarks as the highest performing midrange-server database
- Versions for Unix and NT Server

OnLine Dynamic Server

- Midrange for scalable applications
- Application compatibility down to OnLine and up to XPS
- Particularly well-suited for multiprocessor SMP servers
 - parallel operations
 - low-level parallelism
- Well-suited for complex, large OLTP applications
- Particularly well suited for complex decision support and data warehousing

Extended Parallel Server (XPS)

- High-end parallel database for the largest OLTP and decision support applications
- Applications are compatible with OnLine and Dynamic Server
- Harnesses loosely-coupled clusters and Massively Parallel architectures
- Is just being delivered in Q4-1995
- Competes with parallel RDBMS products from IBM DB2/6000, Oracle & Sybase plus AT&T Teradata

Specialized Database Products

- OnLine Secure Dynamic Server
 - All the features of OnLine Dynamic Server plus a government security rating of B1
 - No extra charge
 - Government and commercial secure applications, including Internet
- OnLine Optical
 - Optical juke box support for read-only image BLOBs
 - Eliminates overhead of managing large image files in the RDBMS

Introducing Informix Parallel Technology [transition]

- Dynamic Server
- Extended Parallel Server

Design Objectives

- Hardware architecture & platform independence
- Transparency to applications
- Core internal parallelism
- Scalability and performance
- Maximum on-line manageability

Transparent to Applications

- [insert graphic here]

Core Internal Parallelism

- [insert graphic here]

Dramatic Performance Increases

- [insert graphic here]

Maximum On-line Manageability

- Objective: avoid database downtime
- On-line dynamic reconfiguration
 - Virtual processors
 - Degree of parallelism
 - Memory management
- On-line parallel backup & recoverability
- Tables, partitions, full or incremental

Extended Parallel Server

- Addresses performance, scalability, and availability issues for
 - Complex transaction processing or decision support
 - Very large databases (> 100 GB)
 - Database failover
- Architecture extends DSA to shared-nothing environment of clusters or MPP
- Ideal where fast response times are critical or where scalability is required but difficult to plan
 - data warehouses
 - client-server applications

XPS Architecture

- [insert figure 1 as graphic here]

RDBMS Database Summary

- An advanced architecture for desktop to massively parallel applications
- Coherent product-line differentiation between On-Line versions
- Informix Advantages
 - Infinite scalability in a shared-nothing architecture
 - Parallel SQL functionality is excellent on SMP
 - High availability
 - Full RDBMS functionality

Database Middleware [transition]

- Replication
- Connectivity

Replication

- Hot-site table-level failover
- Synchronous and asynchronous transfers
- Partition-level, table, or database
- SQL-Select-level replication
- Update anywhere

Connectivity

- Enterprise gateway
- DCE/Net
- Gateway to IBM using DRDA
- XA support for OLTP monitors

Informix in Tools

- \$150M of \$470M in 1994
- Over 500,000 licenses sold
- 75% of partner apps use tools
- Target developers, end users and power users

Application Development [transition]

- NewEra C-S application development
- Informix 4GL
- Informix-SQL suite
- CLI & ESQL

Informix NewEra

- Next-generation environment
- Client-server oriented
- Full object model
- Scalable and high performance

NewEra Features

- OO database application language
- Visual programming environment
- Framework promotes reuse
- Team programming support
- Open connectivity

Informix 4GL

- Powerful database application development tool
- Creates character-based and GUI-lite applications
- Suite provides a complete toolkit for rapid application development

Informix SQL Suite

- RDBMS development tool suite
- Includes
 - Schema editor
 - Menu builder
 - SQL editor
 - Forms builder
 - Report writer

CLI and ESQL

- CLI - a low-level API
- ESQL - embedding SQL
in 3GL programs

End-User Access

- NewEra Viewpoint
 - Query & report writing
 - Graphical SQL access
 - Includes forms, reports & queries
 - Aimed at end and power users

End-User Access

- NewEra Viewpoint Pro
 - Adds to NewEra ViewPoint
 - Application development for power users and IS
 - SuperViews - a powerful tool

Informix Services

- Maintenance & support
- Education
- Limited consulting services
- Third-party partnerships

Aberdeen Group Findings

- A secret success
- Strong database architecture enables parallelism
- Advanced development tools led by NewEra

Aberdeen Group Findings

- Adequate replication & connectivity
- Thousands of applications
- Growth rate indicates increasing market share
- A company focused on database and development tools

